Samsung Electronics 005930.KS 005930 KS

EQUITY: TECHNOLOGY

3Q results in-line; we expect further upsides in memory prices

Quick Note

Rating Remains	Buy
Target price Remains	KRW 670,000
Closing price 7 October 2026	KRW 268,500

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3Q results in-line despite FX headwinds; memory strength to drive further upside

Samsung Electronics (SEC) reported 3Q26 preliminary results with revenue of KRW195tn (+127% y-y) and OP of KRW107tn (+783% y-y), in-line with our estimates. While OP fell short of our estimate of KRW114tn due to the sharp KRW appreciation against USD, we estimate that SEC delivered the highest quarterly OP globally in 3Q26. We estimate SEC's semiconductor OP at ~KRW108tn (including a negative FX impact of ~KRW9tn from ~7% appreciation KRW). We estimate that both commodity DRAM and NAND prices increased by ~15% q-q. Meanwhile, the rapid ramp-up of HBM4 sales, which command a price premium of over 50% vs. HBM3E, likely drove blended DRAM ASP growth of ~16% q-q, outpacing commodity DRAM price increases. Although the foundry business continued to see improvements in revenue and underlying profitability, we estimate that operating losses remained broadly flat q-q at c. -KRW2tn due to bonus-related expenses. The mobile division likely recorded an operating loss of KRW1.4tn, weighed down by rising memory procurement costs and unfavorable FX impact.

4Q26F earnings momentum to continue; 2027F OP to reach KRW640tn

Despite continued FX headwinds from the strengthening KRW, we expect stronger-than-anticipated memory market conditions to drive further earnings growth in 4Q26F, with OP reaching ~KRW120-130tn. We forecast 2027F OP of KRW640tn (+69% y-y).

The weighted average KRW per USD stood in the low-1,400 range in 3Q26, representing ~7% q-q appreciation of KRW. We expect another 4% appreciation in 4Q26F, implying a similar magnitude of negative FX impact on earnings. However, a key change vs. our previous assumptions is that we now expect 4Q26F LTA (long-term agreement) contract prices to rise steeper than initially anticipated.

Our view is that the increased allocation of memory supply under LTAs will further deepen the shortages in non-LTA markets. As memory manufacturers prioritize their limited supply for LTA customers, non-LTA customers are experiencing increasingly severe supply constraints, driving a further acceleration in non-LTA pricing. Importantly, as non-LTA market prices are likely to serve as benchmarks for LTA contract pricing, we believe this dynamic will amplify the overall magnitude of memory price increases.

(continued on the next page)

Fig. 1: SEC – 3Q26 preliminary earnings

	3Q26P (preliminary)							
(K-IFRS, KRWtn)	NMR Est. (Sep 3)	Consensus	Actual	vs. NMR	% q-q	% y-y	2Q26	3Q25
Revenue	**191.16**	**201.90**	**195.00**	**2%**	**14%**	**127%**	**171.50**	**86.06**
Operating profit	**106.66**	**108.67**	**107.40**	**1%**	**20%**	**783%**	**89.49**	**12.17**
%OPM	*55.8%*	*53.8%*	*55.1%*	*-0.7%p*	*2.9%p*	*40.9%p*	*52.2%*	*14.1%*
Semiconductor (DS)	106.55		108.0 (NMR Est)*	1%	21%	1442%	89.32	7.00
Memory	108.59		110.0 (NMR Est)*	1%	19%	1326%	92.40	7.71
Foundry/LSI	(2.04)		(2.0) (NMR Est)*	na	na	na	(3.07)	(0.71)
Display (SDC)	1.06		1.1 (NMR Est)*	4%	57%	-9%	0.70	1.20
MX/Network	(1.34)		(1.4) (NMR Est)*	na	na	na	(0.71)	3.50
Consumer Elec. (VD/DA)	(0.00)		(0.0) (NMR Est)*	na	na	na	(0.00)	(0.13)
Harman	0.32		0.3 (NMR Est)*	-7%	-28%	-25%	0.41	0.40
Net profit	**90.70**	**89.37**			**na**	**na**	**71.27**	**12.01**

Note: NMR Est - refers to our estimates on divisional breakdown of the company's preliminary results. Official breakdown by divisions to be announced on the date of earnings call.
Source: Company data, Bloomberg consensus, Nomura estimates

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That said, LTAs typically incorporate price ceilings, with contract terms varying across both customers and suppliers. As such, visibility remains limited on how elevated non-LTA market prices will ultimately translate into individual memory manufacturers' blended ASPs. We believe Korea memory manufacturers' LTA price ceilings are above 3Q26 market price levels, while non-LTA prices could command substantial premiums over LTA prices in 2027F. Micron (MU US, Not rated) has indicated that LTAs account for about ~35% of its total contracts, although its LTA price ceilings are lower than those of Korean suppliers. In contrast, we believe Korea memory makers have significantly higher LTA exposure, at ~50–70%, and they are likely to benefit from substantially higher LTA price ceilings than Micron's. On the other hand, if non-LTA prices were to exceed the LTA price ceiling, a higher portion of LTA could be a relative disadvantage for Korea memory companies, in our view.

Meanwhile, we expect further earnings deterioration in SEC's downstream set businesses, including mobile devices, due to the combined impact of KRW appreciation and rising memory prices. Nevertheless, we believe their contributions to consolidated OP is becoming increasingly immaterial.

HBM repricing to provide further upside from 1Q27F; substantial shareholder return to support valuation

Starting in 1Q27F, we expect new HBM supply contracts to reflect price increases of 50–100% or more vs. 2026 levels, providing another meaningful earnings growth catalyst. However, even after such substantial price increases, we believe HBM OPM, as well as revenue and OP per wafer, will remain below those of commodity memory products. Thus, we also see room for further HBM price increases throughout 2027F.

We expect SEC to return ~KRW110tn to shareholders in 2026F based on 2026F FCF, of which KRW30tn has already been earmarked for cash dividends. The company is likely to provide further details on the remaining shareholder return measures during either its late-October or January earnings call. We currently expect total cash dividends to reach ~KRW90tn, with the remaining capital allocated to share repurchases and cancellations.

Maintain Buy and TP of KRW670,000; memory supercycle to persist through at least 2028F

We believe many investors remain wary of uncertainties due to structural changes in memory business models and concerns on macroeconomic factors. Nevertheless, we expect the memory market to remain in a supercycle through at least 2028F. Over this period, we estimate a shareholder return yield of ~15–20% based on the current share price, while the FCF yield should be ~30–40%, roughly twice the expected shareholder return yield. We expect the share price to appreciate steadily throughout the super-cycle period. We reiterate our Buy rating on SEC with a TP of KRW670,000.

Appendix A-1

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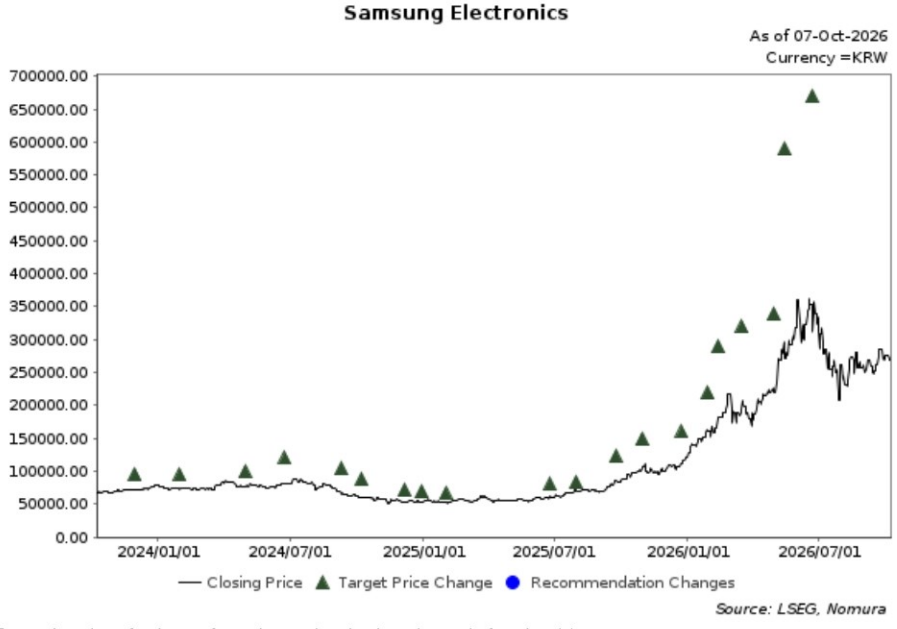
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Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
Samsung Electronics	005930 KS	KRW 268,500	07-Oct-2026	Buy	N/A	

Samsung Electronics (005930 KS) **KRW 268,500 (07-Oct-2026)** Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



Date	Rating	Target price	Closing price
22-Jun-26		670,000.00	353,500.00
15-May-26		590,000.00	270,500.00
30-Apr-26		340,000.00	220,500.00
17-Mar-26		320,000.00	193,900.00
12-Feb-26		290,000.00	178,600.00
29-Jan-26		220,000.00	160,700.00
24-Dec-25		160,000.00	111,100.00
30-Oct-25		150,000.00	104,100.00
24-Sep-25		123,000.00	85,400.00
31-Jul-25		84,000.00	71,400.00
25-Jun-25		80,000.00	61,300.00
01-Feb-25		67,000.00	52,400.00
30-Dec-24		70,000.00	53,200.00
06-Dec-24		72,000.00	54,100.00
08-Oct-24		88,000.00	60,300.00
10-Sep-24		104,000.00	66,200.00
24-Jun-24		120,000.00	80,600.00
30-Apr-24		100,000.00	77,500.00
31-Jan-24		95,000.00	72,700.00
30-Nov-23		96,000.00	72,800.00

For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology Our 12-month TP of KRW670,000 is derived by applying a target P/B of 4.3x to 12MF BVPS. We lower target multiple based on our outlook for ROE soft-landing and higher risk-free rate. The benchmark index for the stock is the KOSPI 200.
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